



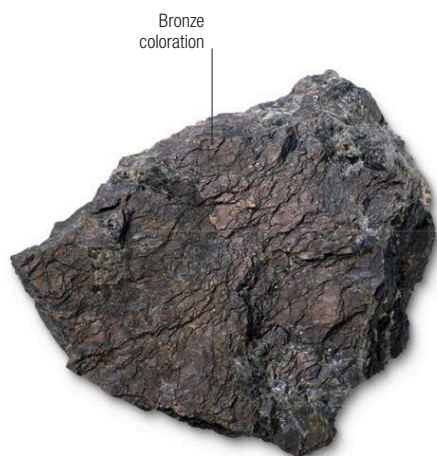
Bronzite

△ **Tumble-polished bronzite** with typical bronze coloration

Bronzite is a member of the mineralogical chemical series that includes hypersthene. The colour of bronzite is green or brown, with schiller (a metallic sheen) that gives it a bronze-like appearance. For gemstone use, it is usually cut *en cabochon*, and it is also carved for small ornamental items. Some bronzite has a fairly distinct fibrous structure, and when this is pronounced, the sheen has a resemblance to cat's eye (see pp.84–85). The general use of bronzite as a gemstone is less extensive than that of its mineralogical cousin, hypersthene.

Specification

Chemical name Iron, magnesium silicate | **Formula** (Mg,Fe) (Si₂O₆) | **Colours** Green, brown, bronze | **Structure** Orthorhombic | **Hardness** 5.5 | **SG** 3.35 | **RI** 1.65–1.67 | **Lustre** Vitreous | **Streak** White to grey | **Locations** India, Germany, Norway, Greenland



Bronzite rock | Rough | The characteristic bronze sheen that gives the stone its name can be seen on the surface of this specimen of bronzite rough.



Tumbled bronzite | Cut | Tumble polishing is a popular means of revealing the bronze-like appearance of the stone, as seen in this piece.



Smooth pebble | Cut | The best coloration in bronzite is not always evident from the rough. This specimen has been polished to a smooth finish, revealing its rich colour.

Bronzite is named for its colour, which resembles polished bronze



Bronzite cabochon | Cut | This rectangular bronzite cabochon has been cut with rounded corners to help avoid chipping. The high dome and smooth surface reveal the bronze-like character and translucency of the material.

Corners rounded off